

Automated Response & SOAR

EDR response actions

Modern EDRs can act *on the endpoint*: terminate process, quarantine file, isolate host, rollback, run script. Combined with automation, containment can happen in seconds.

SOAR (Security Orchestration, Automation, Response)

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Alert -> enrichment (lookup IP/domain/enrichment APIs)
      -> playbook (decision tree)
      -> action (contain via EDR / block via firewall / page analyst)
      -> case (create ticket, SLA, assign)
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Orchestration: glue systems (EDR, SIEM, email, ticketing)

Automation: run the boring steps

Response: sanctioned actions on evidence

Playbook examples

Phishing: extract URLs/hashes → sandbox submit → block domain if malicious → tag user → awareness email

Impossible travel: flag → MFA challenge → session kill → ticket

New admin creation: verify with owner → if unauth → disable + notify DSO

Guarding against automation horror stories

R/A risk: automated isolation can knock prod; gate by severity + confidence

Bypass paths: attacker knows a 'quarantine resets the machine' - don't let them weaponize the tool

Human bottleneck: successful automation must page the *right* human eventually

Danger of false positives: self-contained containment at scale is chaos; ring-fence tests

The human-machine frontier

Automation works for deterministic, high-confidence, low-damage actions. Complex triage stays human. The growth path: 10% of SOC ops handled recursively, playbook for anomalies, then automated only the play-books.

SOAR is a discipline, not a product. Automate the 80% that's boring and deterministic; keep the 20% judgment with a human who has the authority to act.

[← Threat Hunting: Hypothesis-D...](#)

Module complete ✓